

Jensen Huang

A Comprehensive Research Biography

14 June 2026

Contents

1. Introduction
2. Image Gallery
3. Career and Contributions
4. Recent Developments
5. References

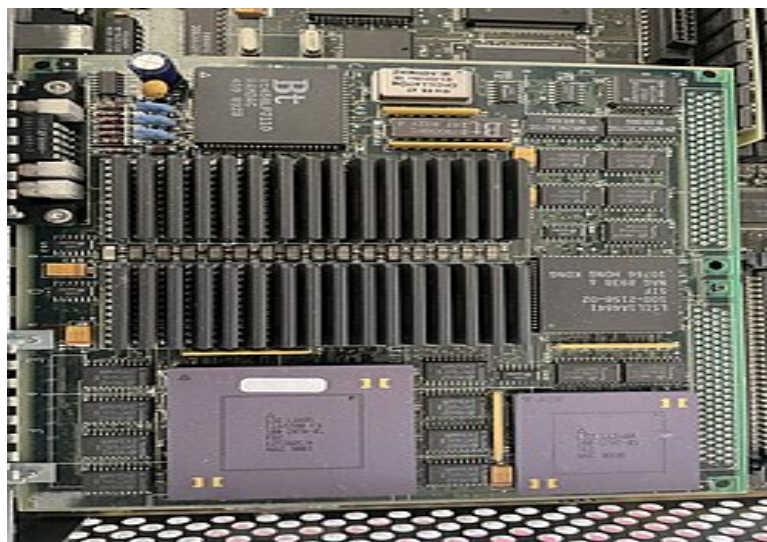
Chapter 1

Introduction

Jen-Hsun "Jensen" Huang (Chinese: 黃仁勳; pinyin: Huáng Rénxūn; Wade–Giles: Huang2 Jên2-hsün1; Tâi-lô: N̂g Jîn-hun; born February 17, 1963) is a Taiwanese and American business executive and electrical engineer who is the founder, president, and CEO of Nvidia, the world's most valuable company. As of 2026, Forbes estimates his net worth at over US\$200 billion, making him the seventh-wealthiest individual in the world. The son of Taiwanese immigrants, Huang spent his childhood in Taiwan and Thailand before moving to the United States, where he was a student in Kentucky and Oregon. After earning a master's degree from Stanford University, Huang launched Nvidia in 1993 from a Denny's restaurant in San Jose, California, at age 30 and has remained its president and CEO ever since. He led the company out of near-bankruptcy during the 1990s and oversaw its expansion into GPU production, high-performance computing, and artificial intelligence (AI). Under Huang, Nvidia experienced rapid growth during the AI boom, becoming the first company to reach a market capitalization of over \$5 trillion in October 2025. In 2021 and 2024, Time magazine included Huang in their list of the most influential people. In 2025, he was named as one of the "Architects of AI" for Time's Person of the Year.

Chapter 2

Image Gallery





Chapter 3

Career and Contributions

Early life and education

Huang was born in Taipei, Taiwan, on February 17, 1963, and moved to the southern city of Tainan as a child. He is the younger of two sons of Huang Hsing-tai, a chemical engineer at an oil refinery, and Lo Tsai-hsiu, a schoolteacher. They were a middle-class Taiwanese family that relocated often, and were native speakers of Taiwanese Hokkien. Each day, Jensen's mother randomly selected 10 words from the dictionary to teach her sons English. When he was five years old, Huang's family moved to Thailand to support his father's refinery career and remained there for approximately four years. He attended Ruamrudee International School while in Bangkok. In the late 1960s, Hsing-tai traveled from Taiwan to New York City to train under an air conditioning company and, after returning home, resolved to send his sons to the United States. At age nine, Jensen, despite not yet being able to speak English fluently, was sent by his parents to live in the United States. He and his older brother moved in 1973 to live with an uncle in Tacoma, Washington, escaping widespread social unrest in Thailand. Both Huang's aunt and uncle were recent immigrants to Washington state; they accidentally enrolled him and his brother in the Oneida Baptist Institute, a religious reform academy in Kentucky for troubled youth, mistakenly believing it to be a prestigious boarding school. In order to afford the academy's tuition, Jensen's parents sold nearly all their possessions. When he was 10 years old, Huang lived with his older brother in the Oneida boys' dormitory. Each student was expected to work every day, and his brother was assigned to perform manual labor on a nearby tobacco farm. Because he was too young to attend classes at the reform academy, Huang was educated at a separate public school—the Oneida Elementary school in Oneida, Kentucky—arriving as "an undersized Asian immigrant with long hair and heavily accented English" and was frequently bullied and beaten. In Oneida, Huang cleaned toilets every day, learned to play table-tennis, joined the swimming team, and appeared in *Sports Illustrated* at age 14. He taught his illiterate roommate, a "17-year-old covered in tattoos and knife scars," how to read in exchange for being taught how to bench press. In 2002, Huang said he remembered his life in Kentucky "more vividly than just about any other". Two years after Huang arrived in Oneida, his parents moved to the United States and settled in Beaverton, Oregon, after which the brothers withdrew from school in Kentucky to live back with them. As a teenager, Huang attended Aloha High School in Aloha, Oregon, where he excelled academically. He skipped two grades, graduated at age 16, and became a nationally ranked table-tennis player in addition to being a member of its mathematics, computer, and science clubs. In 1977, the school purchased an Apple II computer. Huang used the machine to play *Super Star Trek*, a text-based game, and to program in BASIC, creating his own version of *Snake*. Beginning at age 15, Huang got his first job working the graveyard shift at a local Denny's

restaurant as a dishwasher, busboy, and waiter from 1978 to 1983. After high school, he chose to enroll at Oregon State University due to its low in-state tuition. He studied electrical engineering and graduated in 1984 with a bachelor's degree with highest honors. Huang later recalled, "I was the youngest kid in school, in class" and the only student who "looked like a child". Years later, while working as a microchip designer in Silicon Valley, he concurrently pursued graduate night classes at Stanford University, where he earned a master's degree in electrical engineering in 1992.

AMD and LSI Logic

After graduating from college, Huang was a microchip designer in Silicon Valley. He was recruited for positions at Texas Instruments, Advanced Micro Devices (AMD), and LSI Logic, ultimately choosing the California-based AMD due to already being familiar with the company. Huang designed AMD microprocessors while simultaneously attending Stanford and raising his two children. However, when he heard of new chip design processes at LSI Logic, Huang left AMD to assume a role as a technical officer at the LSI Corporation, working under a startup company, Sun Microsystems, where he met engineers Chris Malachowsky and Curtis Priem. LSI was in contract with Sun Microsystems and had introduced Huang to Malachowsky and Priem, who were working on a new graphics accelerator card. While the three produced the card's manufacturing process, the relationship between Malachowsky and Priem became strained as the two disputed the chip's design, leading to infighting; according to Malachowsky, they "broke every tool that LSI Logic had in their standard portfolio". In 1989, Huang, Malachowsky, and Priem finalized the accelerator, which they called the "GX graphics engine". GX was a widespread financial success; the sales of the graphics engine contributed to Sun Microsystem's revenue increasing from \$262 million in 1987 to \$656 million in 1990, and Huang was promoted to be the director of LSI's CoreWare, a division that manufactured chips for hardware vendors.

Nvidia

Founding (1993)

When business began to slow for Sun Microsystems after 1990, Huang, along with Priem and Malachowsky, each resigned their jobs to pursue a venture together in making graphics chips for PC games. They initially named their new company "NVision" until Huang suggested that the company be named "Nvidia" based on the Latin word invidia, as Priem wanted competitors to turn "green with envy". They eventually dropped the "i" to honor the NV1 chip that they were then developing. The three met frequently in 1992 at a Denny's roadside diner in East San Jose to formulate a business plan. Huang chose for them to meet at Denny's due to his prior work experience at the restaurant chain and because it was "quieter than home and had cheap coffee". The three founded the company during one meeting at a breakfast booth at the diner. To formally incorporate the company, Huang found a lawyer, James Gaither of Cooley Godward, who

demanded the \$200 in cash in Huang's pockets to capitalize the company. After that meeting, Huang went back to Priem and Malachowsky to ask each of them for \$200 for their respective shares of the company, which meant that Nvidia's initial capital was \$600. On April 5, 1993, Huang personally signed Nvidia's original articles of incorporation into effect. Although he left LSI, Huang remained in good standing with the company and was able to secure funding for Nvidia from LSI's CEO, Wilfred Corrigan, who introduced Huang to venture capitalist Don Valentine. An account cited how Huang's presentation pitch went badly. Valentine, the leader of Sequoia Capital, chose to invest in Nvidia through Corrigan's support, as did Sutter Hill Ventures. The funding enabled Nvidia to begin development efforts toward its first chip and to begin paying wages for its employees. By the first day of operation, Huang was made Nvidia's president and CEO. Even though Huang, at age 30, was younger than Priem and Malachowsky, both Priem and Malachowsky believed that he was prepared to be CEO. According to Priem, "we basically deferred to Jensen on day one" and told Huang, "you're in charge of running the company—all the stuff Chris and I don't know how to do".

President and CEO (1993–present)

As of 2024, Huang has been Nvidia's chief executive for over three decades, a tenure described by The Wall Street Journal as "almost unheard of in fast-moving Silicon Valley". He owns 3.6% of Nvidia's stock, which went public in 1999. He earned US\$24.6 million as CEO in 2007, ranking him as the 61st highest paid U.S. CEO by Forbes. According to Huang, the three co-founders in 1993 had "no idea how" to start a company, "building Nvidia turned out to have been a million times harder" than they expected, and they probably would not have done it if they had realized up front "the pain and suffering [involved] ... the challenges [they were] going to endure, the embarrassment and the shame, and the list of all the things that [would] go wrong." For its first graphics accelerator chips, Nvidia focused on rendering quadrilateral primitives (forward texture mapping) instead of the triangle primitives preferred by its competitors, and barely survived long enough to successfully pivot to triangles only because Sega agreed to keep Nvidia alive with a \$5 million investment. By the time the RIVA 128 was released in August 1997 and saved the company, Nvidia was down to one month of payroll. This resulted in the "unofficial company motto": "Our company is thirty days from going out of business." Huang regularly began presentations to Nvidia staff with those words for many years. However, Huang regards the "pain and suffering" of Nvidia's early years as essential to the company's success in later years, because it forced him to become a better leader. Huang does not keep a fixed office; he roams Nvidia's headquarters and settles temporarily in conference rooms as needed. He prefers to maintain a relatively flat management structure, with around 60 direct reports as of November 2024, based upon his view that people reporting directly to him "should be at the top of their game" and "require the least amount of pampering". He does not wear a watch, because as he likes to say, "now is the most important time". Historically, Huang and Nvidia were well-known only among the gamers and computer graphics experts who were the original intended markets

for Nvidia's graphics processing unit (GPU) products. In 2017, a Fortune profile article acknowledged: "If you haven't heard of Nvidia, you can be forgiven." During the AI boom, Huang's net worth rose rapidly along with the value of Nvidia's stock, from US\$3 billion in 2019 to US\$90 billion in May 2024. During this same timeframe, Huang became more widely known. In March 2024, Mark Zuckerberg wrote on Instagram with a picture of himself and Huang wearing each other's signature jacket: "He's like Taylor Swift, but for tech". In June 2024, Nvidia's market capitalization reached US\$3 trillion for the first time and Huang's net worth grew to US\$100 billion. By then, the news media was using the term "Jensanity" to refer to Huang's celebrity status in Taiwan, and it was compared to the "Linsanity" phenomenon of 2012. Huang was the center of attention at Computex 2024 in Taipei, even though he was not on the official speaking program. Large crowds of fans and paparazzi followed Huang and his family members around every time they appeared in public during their 2024 visit to Taiwan. In January 2025, Huang delivered the keynote address at the Consumer Electronics Show in Las Vegas. During this keynote, Huang made a number of announcements such as a new gaming GPU series called the GeForce RTX 50 series for both PCs and laptops. In October 2025, Nvidia became the first publicly traded company in the world to reach a market capitalization exceeding \$5 trillion. In 2026, Huang was appointed to the President's Council of Advisors on Science and Technology (PCAST) by President Donald Trump.

Awards

1999: Named Entrepreneur of the Year in High Technology by Ernst & Young 2002: Received the Daniel J. Epstein Engineering Management Award from the University of Southern California 2004: Received the Dr. Morris Chang Exemplary Leadership Award from the Fabless Semiconductor Association, which recognizes a leader who has made exceptional contributions to driving the development, innovation, growth, and long-term opportunities of the fabless semiconductor industry 2005: Named Alumni Fellow by Oregon State University 2007: Received the Silicon Valley Education Foundation's Pioneer Business Leader Award for his work in both the corporate and philanthropic worlds June 2009: Received an honorary doctorate from Oregon State University 2018: Listed in the inaugural Edge 50, naming the world's top 50 influencers in edge computing October 2019: Named best-performing CEO in the world by the Harvard Business Review 2020: Awarded the IEEE Founders Medal November 2020: Named "Supplier CEO of the year" by Automotive News Europe Eurostars November 2020: Received honorary doctorate from National Taiwan University August 2021: Received the Robert N. Noyce Award from the Semiconductor Industry Association (SIA), the industry's highest honor 2021 and 2024: Was included in the Time 100, Time's annual list of the world's 100 most influential people December 2023: Named best CEO of 2023 by The Economist 2023 and 2024: included in Time's list of the 100 most influential people in AI (Time 100/AI) February 2024: Elected to the National Academy of Engineering "for high-powered graphics processing units, fueling the artificial intelligence revolution" May 2024: Recognized as an AI honoree by Gold House September

2024: Selected as a Fellow of the Industrial Technology Research Institute (ITRI) November 2024: Ranked No. 2 by Fortune magazine on its inaugural list of the 100 Most Powerful People in Business November 2024: Received honorary doctorate from Hong Kong University of Science and Technology November 2024: Awarded the Edison Award for "visionary leadership in artificial intelligence and transformative technology" December 2024: Received the grand prize of the VinFuture Prize alongside Yoshua Bengio, Yann LeCun, Geoffrey Hinton, and Fei-Fei Li for their groundbreaking contributions to neural networks and deep learning algorithms February 2025: Awarded the Queen Elizabeth Prize for Engineering, jointly with Yoshua Bengio, Bill Dally, Geoffrey E. Hinton, John Hopfield, Yann LeCun and Fei-Fei Li May 2025: Received honorary doctorate from Linköping University November 2025: Professor Stephen Hawking Fellowship, Cambridge Union, University of Cambridge December 2025: Included in Time's Person of the Year issue. December 2025: Named Financial Times Person of the Year. January 2026: Received the 2026 IEEE Medal of Honor, a prize awarded by IEEE to celebrates visionaries who transform technology and humanity. May 2026: Received an Honorary Doctor of Science and Technology degree from Carnegie Mellon University.

Personal life

While at Oregon State University, Huang met his future wife, Lori Mills, who was his engineering lab partner at the time. They have two children, Spencer and Madison. Spencer launched a bar in Taipei in 2015 that was honored as one of the top 50 bars in Asia by Forbes. The bar closed in April 2021, and he is currently a product manager at Nvidia. Madison previously worked in the hotel industry and is currently director of product marketing at Nvidia. The Huang family lived in ordinary middle-class starter homes in San Jose before Nvidia went public in 1999. In 2003, they moved to a larger house in Los Altos Hills, California, and they acquired a second home in Wailea, Hawaii the following year. In 2017, a limited liability company reportedly linked to the Huangs acquired a mansion in San Francisco for \$38 million. Huang and AMD Chair and CEO Lisa Su are relatives. His mother is the youngest sister of Su's maternal grandfather, making them first cousins, once removed. Huang was unaware of their familial connection until Su became AMD's CEO. A December 2024 investigation by The New York Times reported that Huang had set up an intentionally defective grantor trust and a grantor retained annuity trust. It was estimated that these trusts and his foundation would reduce his family's estate tax by \$8 billion. Huang has dual Taiwanese and American citizenship. During his time at AMD in 1984, Huang, who grew up speaking Taiwanese Hokkien, began learning Mandarin Chinese in order to communicate with Chinese photomask workers employed at the company. He has said that he learned the language phonetically through regular conversations with his co-workers. He makes frequent visits back to Taiwan. Huang and Taiwanese billionaire Charles Liang, co-founder of Supermicro, are longtime friends. Both companies were established in 1993 and have collaborated on products, with the latter utilizing Nvidia AI chips in its servers. Huang is also a close friend of TSMC founder Morris Chang.

Philanthropy

Jensen Huang and his wife, Lori Huang, established the Jen-Hsun & Lori Huang Foundation in 2007 and donated \$330 million of Nvidia shares. The foundation's assets, primarily Nvidia shares, have significantly appreciated, reaching a value exceeding \$12 billion as of late 2025, placing it among the largest private foundations in the United States. Approximately two-thirds of its grants are allocated to donor-advised funds, including the GeForce Fund at Schwab Charitable. In June 2025, the Huangs contributed an additional \$60 million in Nvidia stock to the foundation. In early 2025, the foundation matched a \$22.5 million fundraising effort by the California College of the Arts, contributing an equivalent amount to complete a \$45 million campaign to address the institution's financial deficits and enrollment challenges, marking one of the largest individual gifts in the college's history. The foundation has also provided grants ranging from five to six figures to organizations including the Monterey Bay Aquarium, the Law Foundation of Silicon Valley, the Tides Center, the B612 Foundation, AI4ALL (promoting diversity in artificial intelligence), and Mental Health Innovations (developing technology-based mental health solutions). In accordance with Internal Revenue Service regulations for private foundations, the foundation disbursed \$123 million in 2024 and was projected to distribute \$369 million in 2025.

See also

Huang's law – Computer science observation

References

Additional sources

Witt, Stephen (2025). *The Thinking Machine: Jensen Huang, Nvidia, and the World's Most Coveted Microchip*. Penguin Publishing Group. ISBN 9780593832691.

External links

"An Interview with Jen Hsun Huang". *Wired*, July 2002. Volume 10, number 7. Nvidia Corporate Biography Jen-Hsun Huang (2015). "GPU Technology Conference 2015 - Leaps in Visual Computing". Retrieved March 26, 2015. Appearances on C-SPAN After Words interview with Stephen Witt on *The Thinking Machine: Jensen Huang, Nvidia, and the World's Most Coveted Microchip*. April 25, 2025. C-SPAN.

Chapter 4

Recent Developments and Current Work

Jensen Huang Just Told Investors to Buy This Under-the-Radar Artificial Intelligence (AI) Chip Stock (Hint: It's Not Marvell) - The Motley Fool

The Motley Fool | 2026-06-11

Jensen Huang recently praised another artificial intelligence (AI) chip stock during his trip to South Korea.

Nvidia's Jensen Huang has 2 words for your AI job fears - thestreet.com

thestreet.com | 2026-06-11

Nvidia's Jensen Huang has 2 words for your AI job fears thestreet.com

Nvidia CEO Jensen Huang Says This Will Be the Next \$1 Trillion Company - Yahoo Finance

Yahoo Finance | 2026-06-13

Nvidia (NASDAQ: NVDA) CEO Jensen Huang isn't shy about telling investors what stocks to buy. He is well-connected in the chip industry and knows which companies have great products and are destined for success. His recent prediction is that Marvell (NASDAQ: MRVL) will be the next \$1 trillion company. That's no small bet, as Marvell is currently a \$220 billion company. So, if Huang is right, he's basically telling investors about a stock that can nearly 5x. That's a great gain and is well worth looking into, but what makes Marvell so special? Missed Nvidia in 2009? This Rare Signal Is Flashing Again. In 2009, a "Double Down" signal flashed for a little-known chipmaker called Nvidia. For the first time in years, that same "Total Conviction" signal is flashing for a company 1/100th the size of Nvidia. Continue » The one thing you have to give Huang credit for is that he's propping up a company that Nvidia is outright competing against in one area, yet supporting in another. Marvell has many products, but the ones that get investors most excited are its application-specific integrated circuits (ASICs) and its high-speed networking chips. On the ASIC front, Marvell helps Amazon design its custom AI chips for Amazon Web Services, which is an outright competitor to Nvidia's GPUs. However, that's not where Huang is focused. Instead, Huang recognizes Marvell's networking chips as best-in-class and announced a partnership with

Nvidia to ensure that Marvell and Nvidia's technology are compatible with each other. This secures Nvidia's compatibility in future data centers as Marvell's connectivity infrastructure coexists alongside Nvidia's computing products . This shows that the AI arms race isn't a winner-take-all event. Instead, there will be several companies that are winners, allowing investors to profit from all sorts of companies. But Marvell still has a way to go before reaching the \$1 trillion club. For Marvell to join the \$1 trillion club, it needs a stock price of \$1,140. If we assign an arbitrary 30 times earnings valuation as a reasonable price tag for a big tech stock involved in the AI build-out, then Marvell would need to generate earnings per share of \$38. For its current fiscal year (FY) 2027 (ending January 2027), Wall Street estimates it will generate about \$4.05 in EPS. So, Marvel must undergo some major growth before it reaches the \$1 trillion level at a reasonable valuation. We'll see how Huang's projection pans out, but for Marvell to be "the next" \$1 trillion company is likely not happening anytime soon. However, it could reach that point someday if it can continue partnering with leading AI companies and deliver solid results over the long term. The Motley Fool Stock Advisor analyst team just identified what they believe are the 10 best stocks for investors to buy now... and Marvell Technology wasn't one of them. The 10 stocks that made the cut are built for long-term growth and could produce monster returns in the coming years. Consider when Netflix made this list on December 17, 2004... if you invested \$1,000 at the time of our recommendation, you'd have \$438,283 !* Or when Nvidia made this list on April 15, 2005... if you invested \$1,000 at the time of our recommendation, you'd have \$1,257,427 !* That performance is why people listen. With a track record of beating the S&P 500 by nearly 5x , Stock Advisor offers a distinct advantage. Don't miss the latest top 10 list, available with Stock Advisor , and join an investing community built for the long haul. Keithen Drury has positions in Amazon and Nvidia. The Motley Fool has positions in and recommends Amazon, Marvell Technology, and Nvidia. The Motley Fool has a disclosure policy . Nvidia CEO Jensen Huang Says This Will Be the Next \$1 Trillion Company was originally published by The Motley Fool

Why AI token prices are about to plummet - Business Insider

Business Insider | 2026-06-12

Nvidia's Blackwell systems could flood the market with cheap AI tokens, driving down costs and reshaping the economics of AI.

Quote of the day by Nvidia CEO Jensen Huang: “One of my great advantages is that I have very low...” - The Times of India

The Times of India | 2026-06-12

The TOI Tech Desk is a dedicated team of journalists committed to delivering the latest and most relevant news from the world of technology to readers of The Times of India. TOI Tech Desk's news coverage spans a wide spectrum across gadget launches, gadget reviews, trends, in-depth

analysis, exclusive reports and breaking stories that impact technology and the digital universe. Be it how-tos or the latest happenings in AI, cybersecurity, personal gadgets, platforms like WhatsApp, Instagram, Facebook and more; TOI Tech Desk brings the news with accuracy and authenticity. [Read More](#)

References

- 1 https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Jensen_Huang
- 2 <https://www.fool.com/investing/2026/06/11/jensen-huang-just-told-investors-to-buy-this-ai/>
- 3 <https://www.thestreet.com/employment/nvidias-jensen-huang-has-2-words-for-your-ai-job-fears>
- 4 <https://www.fool.com/investing/2026/06/13/nvidia-ceo-jensen-huang-says-this-will-be-the-next/>
- 5 <https://www.businessinsider.com/ai-token-price-crash-nvidia-blackwell-gpus-2026-6>
- 6 <https://timesofindia.indiatimes.com/technology/tech-news/quote-of-the-day-by-nvidia-ceo-jensen-huang-one-of-my-great-advantages-is-that-i-have-very-low-/articleshow/131692397.cms>